

Brian W. Smith

PRINCIPAL SITE RELIABILITY ENGINEER · FEDRAMP HIGH · CLOUD-NATIVE INFRASTRUCTURE

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25+ YEARS IN PRODUCTION	100+ FEDRAMP-HIGH OPENSIFT CLUSTERS OPERATED	FedRAMP HIGH & MODERATE ATO	700+ NIST 800-53 CONTROLS EVALUATED
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SUMMARY

Principal SRE at Red Hat with 25+ years of enterprise infrastructure experience, specializing in FedRAMP High and Moderate compliance, Zero Trust architecture, cloud-native platform engineering, and security automation at scale. Deep expertise in OpenShift/Kubernetes, AWS GovCloud, Terraform IaC, and NIST 800-53 Rev 5 control implementation. Proven track record of building greenfield platforms, leading cross-functional teams, and delivering compliance-driven engineering across regulated federal environments. Currently leading FIPS cryptographic validation, Secret Management platform engineering, FedRAMP Moderate remediation, and AI-powered compliance automation across the ROSA (Red Hat OpenShift Service on AWS) Regional Platform.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

▸ OpenShift / Kubernetes (CKA)	▸ FedRAMP High ATO	▸ NIST 800-53 Rev 5
▸ AWS GovCloud / PrivateLink	▸ Terraform / Infrastructure as Code	▸ Splunk / Dynatrace / Prometheus / Grafana
▸ Bash / Python / Go	▸ CI/CD (Tekton, Jenkins, GitLab)	▸ Keycloak / IAM / SSO
▸ Claude AI / MCP / Agent SDK	▸ GitOps / ArgoCD / Helm / Kustomize	▸ Incident Response / Continuous Monitoring (CONMON)
▸ HashiCorp Vault / Secrets Management	▸ Zero Trust / FIPS 140-3	

EXPERIENCE

Principal SRE (January 2026 – Present)

- Implemented 13+ NIST 800-53 Rev 5 control families (AU, AC, SC, SI, RA, IA, CA, CP) for FedRAMP Moderate compliance across the ROSA Regional Platform, mapping each against HCP (Hosted Control Plane) Terraform modules to produce a gap-closed control inventory.
- Deployed a Thanos/Prometheus/Alertmanager/Grafana observability suite via parameterized IaC, enabling single-variable regional rollouts across all ROSA environments.
- Designed and deployed a Secret Management framework via AWS Secrets Manager and Vault sidecar injection, enforcing least-privilege IAM policies per service and eliminating plaintext secrets across all repositories.
- Built a Python/DynamoDB Sandbox account leasing system provisioning scoped IAM roles and SCPs with auto-reclaim, cutting environment setup from hours to minutes.
- Architected a 3-tier AWS CodePipeline GitOps hierarchy with a meta-pipeline provisioner dynamically managing per-cluster pipelines from Git commits, paired with ArgoCD ApplicationSet Matrix Generators for zero-config multi-cluster delivery.
- Eliminated VPC peering and Transit Gateway coupling by engineering zero-trust cross-cluster messaging over AWS IoT Core MQTT; deployed ECS Fargate bootstrap-then-handoff for fully private EKS initialization and a 17-module reusable Terraform library; built ephemeral CI environments (provision → e2e → teardown via Prow) with k6 load testing and S3-baseline regression detection.
- Automated FedRAMP compliance evaluation via a Claude Sonnet sub-agent pipeline assessing ~700 Moderate and ~100 High-only NIST 800-53 Rev 5 controls — 7-step workflow (clone → classify → analyze → report → PDF → Drive → Jira/PR), 12 artifacts per run, with Trivy CVE integration auto-downgrading Met controls on CRITICAL/HIGH findings.
- Led cross-vendor FIPS validation for OCP on EKS, using negative-control testing on Go binary dlopen dispatch paths to `/proc/sys/crypto/fips_enabled` to distinguish infrastructure-level from binary-level enforcement; collaborated with Red Hat cryptographic maintainers on KAT tests for NIST SP 800-131A AES/RSA/ECDSA compliance.

Principal SRE - Team Lead (January 2025 – January 2026)

- Led FedRAMP COMMON remediation across a fleet of clusters; resolved SRE emergency access blockers by integrating backplane-cli/backplane-api with FedRAMP-compliant auth protocols.
- Architected AWS PrivateLink for ROSA HCP across all GovCloud regions with cross-account VPC Peering.
- Led the migration of 8 ROSA clusters across 2 GovCloud regions from classic to Hosted Control Plane (HCP) architecture, driving cross-functional coordination across multiple Red Hat engineering and product teams to deliver a successful FedRAMP compliance assessment.
- Developed and delivered 10+ technical training sessions on ROSA HCP to SRE teams across all GovCloud regions, driving large-scale adoption of a newly launched managed control-plane architecture and reducing time-to-productivity for engineers onboarding to the platform.
- Deployed Dynatrace Managed Service across FedRAMP environments with OneAgent log forwarding; engineered a Keycloak → Splunk log pipeline for centralized audit trails and real-time authentication security monitoring; authored SCR architecture diagrams and ADRs for External DNS Operator and HCP authorization.

Senior SRE Functional Lead (December 2023 – January 2025) · Senior SRE (November 2021 – December 2023)

- Led a team of 9 SREs; defined and drove agile epics aligned with business priorities — CVE mitigation, annual FedRAMP assessments, Significant Change Requests, and operational toil reduction.
- Deployed Red Hat build of Keycloak (RHBK) to production, authored six FedRAMP Boundary Architecture Diagrams, and engineered real-time synthetic availability monitoring for the identity platform.
- Automated AWS Config, GuardDuty, and SecurityHub via Terraform to establish the FedRAMP security baseline; authored the SSP Access Control validation epic for the ROSA Regional Platform.

- Led GoAlert deployment as the FedRAMP on-call platform from PoC through VPCE network architecture to production, replacing PagerDuty and reducing on-call escalation latency.
- Built the greenfield FedRAMP High GovCloud platform on AWS; established Terraform as the IaC provisioning foundation; led ATO workstreams including annual FedRAMP assessment support.
- Architected Transit Gateway hub-and-spoke topology for GovCloud; drove global VPC Flow Logs rollout and WAF compliance audit across all high-compliance regions.

OneStream Software

FIRST DEVOPS ENGINEER

February 2021 – November 2021

- As the organization's first DevOps engineer, migrated 70+ repositories from TFS to Azure DevOps and established CI/CD foundations including SonarQube SAST, GitFlow branching, and Azure Pipelines.

Immuta

CLOUD ENGINEER

August 2020 – February 2021

- Deployed and configured Immuta's data security platform for enterprise customers across Databricks, Athena, Snowflake, and Redshift, applying Kubernetes expertise to accelerate onboarding across data warehouse environments.

Fiserv

SENIOR SYSTEM ENGINEER LEAD – CLOUD PLATFORM

March 2017 – August 2020

- Designed and built 16 Pivotal Cloud Foundry foundations supporting 7,000+ microservices; deployed Kubernetes into Azure using Pivotal Kubernetes Service (PKS/TKGI).
- Led Fiserv's PaaS deployment to Azure and authored the enterprise Terraform infrastructure; presented the hybrid-cloud Terraform architecture at SpringOne 2019.
- Built a self-service Kubernetes cluster provisioning platform (web form → Git → pipeline → Helm-deployed Prometheus/Grafana stack + expiration cleanup); designed centralized SLI dashboards across 14 PAS foundations using Grafana, AlertManager, and Prometheus.
- Formed and trained the Cloud Platform team, establishing agile delivery practices across the enterprise Kubernetes and PaaS program.

Earlier Roles

GRANGE INSURANCE (SENIOR SYSTEM ENGINEER) • NETJETS (SR. NETWORK ADMIN) • BMW FINANCIAL (CRM ADMIN) • CARDINAL HEALTH (SR. MESSAGING ENGINEER) • WD PARTNERS (IT ADMIN)

1998 – 2008

- 25+ years of progressive infrastructure experience spanning messaging, networking, virtualisation, enterprise AD/Exchange, and automation — from first ISP support role (BellSouth.net) through senior engineering leadership.

CERTIFICATIONS		EDUCATION & NOTABLE	
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)	CKA-2000-008308-0100	Franklin University — Computer Science	Columbus, OH
Azure DevOps Engineer Expert (AZ-400)	December 2020	Eagle Scout — Order of the Arrow	Boy Scouts of America
Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-303/304)	October 2020	SpringOne 2019 Speaker	Pivotal Platform / Azure
Azure Administrator Associate (AZ-104)	October 2020	Open Source Contributor	github.com/theautoroboto